

# Proposed Thematic Structure

Based on expert interviews by Zelal Kaskin (2026) for this initiative.

## The red thread

### **1. What is human-centered AI?**

→ Define the principle.

### **2. Who remains in control?**

→ Establish human agency and responsibility.

### **3. What happens to meaningful human work?**

→ Examine the consequences for people and work.

### **4. How should humans and AI collaborate?**

→ Design roles, autonomy and workflows.

### **5. What human capabilities need to be preserved/developed?**

→ Ensure people remain capable of using and questioning AI.

### **6. How do we ensure quality and human oversight?**

→ Control reliability and outputs.

### **7. Where are the risks and boundaries?**

→ Define where and under which conditions AI should be used.

### **8. What organisational structures are needed?**

→ Establish governance, participation and protection.

### **9. How does the organisation continuously adapt?**

→ Treat human-centered AI as an ongoing organisational process.

## 1. Human-Centered AI: Core Principles

### What is human-centered AI?

Human-centered AI is understood as AI that **supports humans rather than replacing them**. AI should remain a tool, while human needs, capabilities, autonomy and responsibility remain central. AI may appear human-like, but should not be mistaken for human cognition, emotions or understanding.

- AI as a complementary tool
- Human needs, capabilities and dignity as reference points
- Awareness of AI's limitations and non-human nature

## 2. Human Agency & Autonomy

### Who remains in control?

A central principle is that **humans retain decision authority and responsibility**. The extent of AI autonomy should therefore be deliberately defined, rather than allowing AI to determine processes by default.

- Human-in-the-loop / Human Supervisor
- Human exception (e.g. AI project manager -> in one section there will be just one manager of that section left)
- AI as advisor rather than decision-maker
- Self-determined use of AI by employees
- Defined boundaries for AI autonomy (especially AI agents)

## 3. Meaningful Work & Human Well-Being

### What happens to meaningful human work?

AI changes which tasks humans perform and may remove routine work. This can create opportunities for more meaningful activities, but also risks **loss of competence, professional identity, connectedness and meaning** when too much of the human contribution disappears.

- feeling needed
- Competence and self-efficacy
- Autonomy and social connectedness
- Changing tasks and job requirements -> new job crafting
- Risk of deskilling, dissociation

- Workload, pressure and increasing task switching -> risk of becoming strategic manager of AI agents

## 4. Human–AI Collaboration & Work Design

### How should humans and AI collaborate?

AI should not simply be added to existing work. **Roles, tasks and workflows may need to be redesigned.** The appropriate degree of AI autonomy depends on the task and context, organisation.

### AI role and autonomy

- Defined functions and responsibilities for AI
  - Restrictive ↔ loose AI use depending on the task
    - Restrictive: close iterative collaboration between human and AI
    - Loose: human in the loop (as last step)
- > AI as preparatory/supportive vs. more autonomous execution

### Work process

- Clear allocation of human and AI tasks
- Workflow and process redesign (e.g. via principal researcher for AI use)
- Feedback loops and iterative interaction

### Collaboration

- Most efficient: human expertise guiding AI in its own expertise compared to someone else
- AI as sparring / research partner
- Humans checking and steering AI outputs

## 5. Human Capabilities & Learning

### What human capabilities need to be preserved/developed?

AI use requires humans to develop the ability to **work with, question and regulate AI**, rather than simply **consuming** its outputs and **rushing** with it. It is important to actively learn in order to remain human expertise.

- AI literacy and domain expertise
- Ability to verify and question AI outputs
- Risk of cognitive deskilling

- Co cognition (iterative constructive use of AI) should be on: fast processes does not mean fast learning, it can even slow down learning)
- **Self-regulation** as BIG important future skill of AI use
- **Top down** pressure from C-lvl does not allow learning setting
- **Bottom Up** perspective of employees need a setting to experiment with AI without fearing mistakes because of C-lvl's pressure

## 6. Quality, Trust & Human Oversight

### How do we ensure quality and human oversight?

AI outputs require human evaluation, particularly where mistakes have significant consequences. Trust therefore depends not only on AI performance but also on **verification, transparency and the ability to recognise uncertainty.**

- Human verification as quality control
- Fact-checking and source validation
- Hallucinations and bias
- Explainability vs. black-box AI
- AI communicating uncertainty / asking for clarification
- Speed vs. precision and quality as trade off
- AI agents can break “hard rules” even if clearly prompted !

## 7. Risk, Boundaries & Context

### Where are the risks and boundaries?

The appropriate use of AI depends strongly on **what is being done, which information is involved and what consequences errors could have.** High-stakes and sensitive contexts require greater restrictions and human involvement.

- Healthcare, HR, public-sector and client-facing contexts
- Differentiated access to organisational data (as it is usual for employees must be as well) for AI agents!
- Employee monitoring and surveillance risks
- Ethical boundaries
- Environmental impact of AI use

## 8. Organisational Governance & Participation

### What organisational structures are needed?

Human-centered AI cannot be achieved only through individual employee behaviour. Organisations need **rules, responsibilities, transparency and participation** to shape how AI is introduced and used.

- Organisational accountability
- Ethical guidelines and governance
- Legal requirements and regulation
- Employee participation and co-design
- Transparency about AI use and data processing
- Employee protection / works council (neutrally independently positioned) establishment in organisation
- Cross-functional AI expertise as an own section in an organisation if needed
- Addressing shadow AI

## 9. Continuous Adaptation & Implementation

### How does the organisation continuously adapt?

Because AI develops rapidly, human-centered AI is described as an **ongoing process rather than a one-time implementation**. Organisations need to continuously evaluate AI use, adapt processes and train employees instead of simply trying to keep up with technological speed.

- Step-by-step AI implementation
- Continuous evaluation and feedback
- Adaptation of workflows and roles
- Continuous employee training
- Reassessment of AI use and risks
- Avoiding technology-first or rushed implementation
- Maintaining a human pace rather than simply following AI speed